Akiho Kawada

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Pronouns she/her/hers
Website https://akiho-kawada.github.io/

(last update: June 2026)

Education

Aug 2026 - **University of Texas at Austin**
Ph.D. in Electrical and Computer Engineering
Advisor: Prof. Neeraja Yadwadkar

Apr 2021 - Mar 2026 **University of Tokyo**
Bachelor of Engineering in Systems Innovation
Thesis Advisors: Prof. Yutaka Matsuo and Prof. Yusuke Iwasawa

Publications

2024 **A 250.3μW Versatile Sound Feature Extractor Using 1024-Point FFT 64-ch LogMel Filter in 40nm CMOS**
Akiho Kawada*, Kenji Kobayashi*, Jaewon Shin, Rei Sumikawa, Mototsugu Hamada, Atsutake Kosuge
IEEE Asia Pacific Conference on Circuits and Systems (APCCAS) 2024

Experience

Jun 2025 - Jan 2026 **Cornell Tech**
Undergraduate Researcher

- Advisor: Prof. Udit Gupta
- Analyzing system-level configuration and architecture choices for efficient RAG execution.

Apr 2023 - Jan 2025 **University of Tokyo**
Thesis Student

- Advisor: Prof. Yutaka Matsuo and Prof. Yusuke Iwasawa
- Explored training-free network pruning methods by identifying high-performing sparse sub-networks with fixed initial weights.

Oct - Dec 2024 **University of California, Santa Barbara**
Visiting Student Researcher

- Advisor: Prof. Jonathan Balkind
- Designed hardware acceleration for memory allocation, enabling on-chip accelerators to issue allocation/free requests through a unified system interface.

May - Aug 2024 **Google Summer of Code**
GSoC Student / Contributor

- Mentors: Dr. Jonathan Balkind, Dr. César Fuguet Tortolero, and Noelia Oliete Escuín
- Project: Transforming the OpenHW High Performance Data Cache into a High Performance Instruction Cache

Oct 2023 - Jun 2024 **University of Tokyo**
Undergraduate Researcher

- Advisor: Prof. Atsutake Kosuge
- Conducted RTL design and FPGA validation of pre-processing hardware modules for energyefficient DNNs.

Dec 2022 - Jan 2024 **Akari Inc.**
Machine Learning Engineer Intern

- Employment type: Full-time (Feb–Mar, Aug–Sep 2023); Part-time (other months)

Honors and Awards

- **Cockrell School of Engineering - Engineering Scholarship (2026–)**
- **Funai Overseas Scholarship (2026–2028)** — Awarded tuition and stipend support ($50,000 per year).
- **University of Tokyo Musha Shugyo Program (2024)** — Granted 2 months of stipend and travel support.